

Activities: Chat



The Chat activity module enables participants to have text-based, real-time synchronous discussions. The Chat may be a one-time activity or it may be repeated at the same time each day or each week. Chat sessions are saved and can be made available for everyone to view or restricted so that users only have the ability to view chat session logs.

Chats are especially useful when students are not able to meet face-to-face. Some examples of how an Instructor may use Chats are:

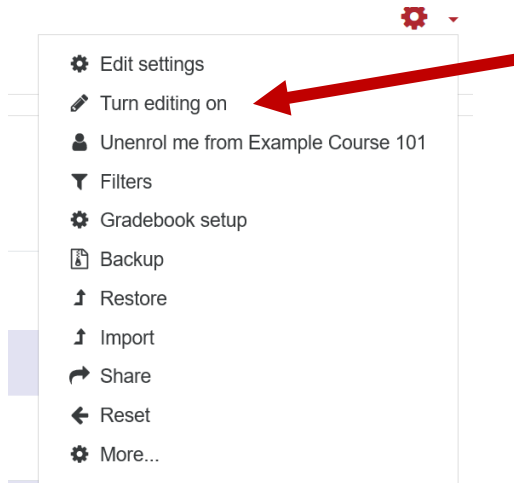
1. Regular meetings with online students to enable their sharing of experiences with others.
2. A student temporarily unable to attend class in person or synchronously online; they can chat with their instructor to catch up with work.
3. Students out on work terms getting together to discuss their experiences with each other and their instructor.
4. Sessions to help students prepare for tests where the instructor, or other students, could pose sample questions.

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To Add a Chat Room:

1. Turn editing on by clicking on the Settings icon (top right of course page) and selecting 'Turn editing on' from the dropdown menu.



2. Click the 'Add an activity or resource' button on the bottom right of the section (location) where you want to add the new file.

+ Add an activity or resource

3. A pop-up window will appear on your screen. Scroll down. Under 'Activities,' select the 'Chat' option. Click 'Add' at the bottom of the window.



Edit Settings:

▼ General

1

Name of this chat room !

2

Description

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☐ Display description on course page ?

1. Fill in the **Chat name**. Ensure the name of the Chat identifies the purpose of the Chat activity. For example, 'Chat for studying for Mid-term' or 'Chat for asking Instructor Questions.'
2. In the **Description** field you may give the student more details on the Chat activity. You may display the Description on the course page if you select the **Display description on the course page** box. Only do this if it is imperative to give the students further directions before they enter the Chat. Having descriptions on the course page 'clutters' the home page, making navigation through your course more difficult for the student.

▼ Chat sessions

3

Next chat time

7 ▼

December ▼

2018 ▼

09 ▼

52 ▼

📅

4

Repeat/publish session times

Don't publish any chat times ▼

5

Save past sessions

Never delete messages ▼

6

Everyone can view past sessions ?

No ▼

3. **Next Chat time** is when this virtual chat room will be open for use. It is important to have the correct day, year and time that you would like to use this feature.
4. **Repeat/publish session times** can be used for daily or weekly chats. The time you select does not enable/disable the chat room. It only tells students when to expect activity, by publishing the date in the calendar. If you need to, you can hide the chat room between sessions by using the *Hide* option in the Common Module Settings (or using the Edit button on your course front page).

5. If you want to **Save past sessions**, you can use the drop-down menu to set how long chat messages persist. The minimum is 2 days; the maximum is forever.
6. **Everyone can view past sessions:** If set to no, then only instructors and moderators can view the chat logs.

▼ Common module settings

8	Availability	?	Show on course page ▾
9	ID number	?	
7	Group mode	?	No groups ▾
	Grouping	?	None ▾

Add group/grouping access restriction

7. **Group Mode and Grouping:** Group mode and Grouping only works if you have already set up Groups/Groupings for the course. If you have Groups in your course, the following options are available.
 - No Groups** means everyone is in the same community.
 - Separate Groups** means students can only chat with their own group
 - Visible Groups** means students can read other groups, but only post in their own
 - Add group/grouping access restriction** add a group or grouping access restriction (affects the Restrict Access section by adding a restriction there).
8. **Availability:** Shows or hides the chat room on the course page. This is a means to disable a Chat.
 - Hidden from students:** Instructors will see the Chat (light grey to show it is hidden), but students will not be able to see the activity.
 - Show on course page:** Visible to all.
9. **ID number** is used for custom gradebook calculations, should you choose to grade the chat activity (normally this activity is not graded).
10. Click **Save** to finish setting up the chat.

Using a Chat

Entering the chat

When you enter the Chat, the **Chat Name** and **Directions** will appear on the top of the window. You may enter the Chat by clicking on the **Click here to enter the chat now** or **Use more accessible interface**. The appearance of the Chat differs for the accessible interface, having a more appealing, easier to follow application. (See screen shots below.)

What else you see when entering a Chat depends upon your settings. If you have groups in your course, you will have a drop down box to delineate who you are chatting with; the entire class or specific groups and whether they can view each other's chats.

Questions about the Mid-term

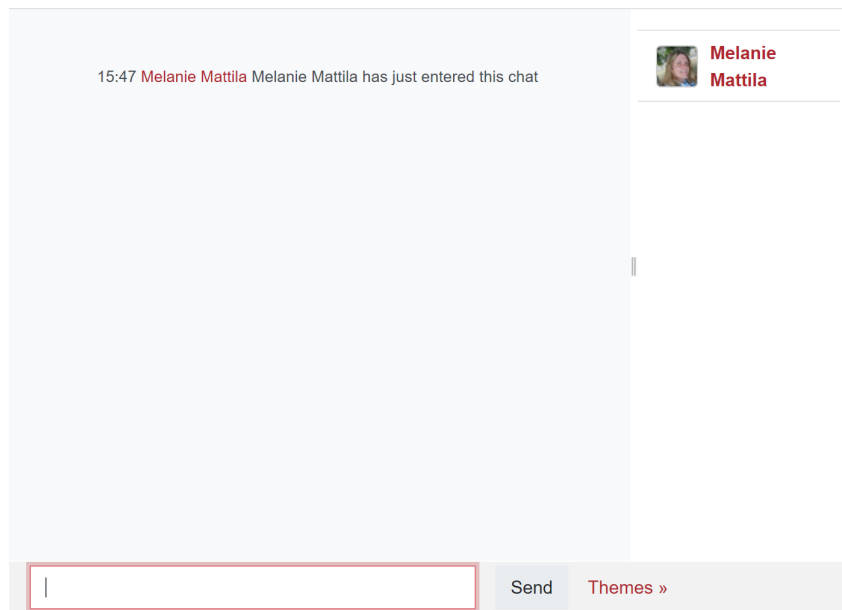


Please enter your questions and suggestions about the mid-term. Weigh in on what you think should be on the mid-term. Maybe I will give you a few emoticon hints if I agree with your suggestions.

[Click here to enter the chat now](#)

[Use more accessible interface](#)

Click here to enter the Chat: The Chat window appears as a pop-up.



The screenshot shows a chat window with a light blue header. On the left, it says "15:47 Melanie Mattila" and "Melanie Mattila has just entered this chat". On the right, there is a profile picture of a woman and the name "Melanie Mattila" in red. Below the header is a large text input area. At the bottom, there is a text input field with a red border, a "Send" button, and a "Themes »" link.

Use a more accessible interface: The more accessible interface provides a simpler looking chat. To see the newest chat messages, click on the *Refresh* button (this mode does not automatically update).

Example Course 101

Questions about the Mid-term

Participants



Melanie Mattila Idle 2 mins 31 secs

Send message

Submit

Refresh

☐ Show only new

Messages

No messages were found

From	Message	Time
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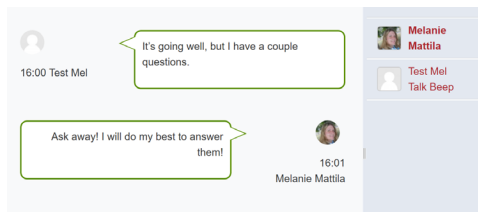
Two choices on Themes (or how the chats appear)

Send

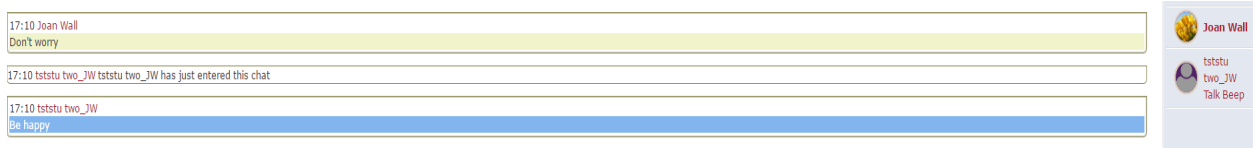
Themes »

In normal view, the screen is in two parts with the participants on the right, the messages on the left and a box at the bottom into which users type their message and press "**Send**" to make their contribution. Under **Theme** there are two additional viewing options: Bubbles and Compact. (See below.)

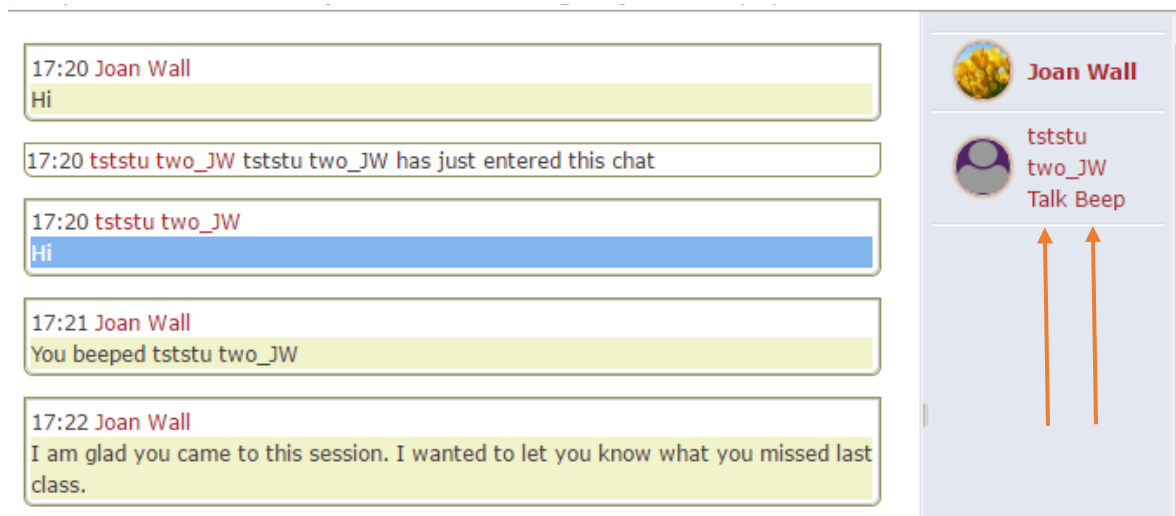
Bubbles theme: Text appears in speech bubbles.



Compact theme: Information presented in a more linear fashion.

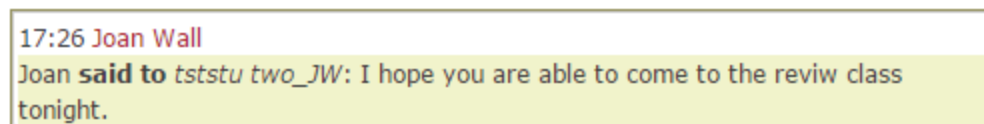


Beep and Talk



You can send a sound to other people by selecting the **Beep** link next to their name. A useful shortcut to beep all the people in the chat at once is to type "**beep all**". This is used to get the attention of somebody else.

If you click the '**Talk**' link by a person's name, it will then add their name in the chat box to show your message is directed at that particular person.



Past Chat Sessions

You may **View past chat sessions**. This will bring up a listing of each chat session under the current chat topic. The listings include the time the chat started and ended, which users participated, and how many messages each user sent. Individual sessions may be deleted by clicking the '**Delete**' link.

Click here to enter the chat now

Use more accessible interface

View past chat sessions

Logs

You may also view **Logs** by clicking on the Settings icon (top right side of course page) and selecting *Logs*. This will show you all the activity in the **Chat**. You may select one student to see their participation in the Chat. If you are interested in viewing one student, you may also select **Create** on the drop down menu for **All actions** to view when the student posted to the Chat versus when they viewed the Chat.

Example Course 101	All participants	All days	Questions about the Mid-term
All actions	All sources	All events	Get these logs

Time	User full name	Affected user	Event context	Component	Event name	Description	Origin	IP address
7 December 2018, 4:35 PM	Melanie Mattila	-	Chat: Questions about the Mid-term	Chat	Course module viewed	The user with id '5' viewed the 'chat' activity with course module id '833'.	web	24.65
7 December 2018, 4:07 PM	Melanie Mattila	-	Chat: Questions about the Mid-term	Chat	Course module viewed	The user with id '5' viewed the 'chat' activity with course module id '833'.	web	24.65

Delete a Chat

1. Go to the course home page.
2. Click on the **Settings** icon and select *Turn editing on* from the dropdown menu.
3. Click **Edit** next to the Chat you would like to delete.
4. Click **Delete**.

Notes:

When you enter a Chat, you do not see the messages prior to your arrival. Stress to the students that, if they want to see all the chats, they should arrive in the Chat at the appropriate time, especially if you as the instructor are not allowing the students to view past Chat sessions.

For additional information, contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca.